

Halloween Monster Night

STARRING MIA AND MOXIE



MonstersNOW - Illustrated review proof



Halloween Monster Night

A MonstersNOW story



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Starring Mia and Moxie

This book belongs to a one-of-a-kind monster maker.





Big stories from little imaginations.

Created from an original monster drawing.

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The porch lights were on. Pumpkins lined the steps. Down the street, someone was already calling, “Trick or treat!” Mia grabbed an empty treat bucket and hurried to the door. Moxie was waiting outside.



“Ready, Moxie?”

They had treats to collect and a parade to catch. It was Moxie’s first Halloween, and Mia wasn’t about to miss a thing.



The town square was crowded with witches, ghosts, and children dressed as pumpkins. Everyone wanted a good spot beside the giant pumpkin lantern.



Nearby, on a red cushion, sat the Monster Star.
“Watch that star,” Mia told Moxie. “When they put it on top, all the pumpkins light up. Then the parade starts!”



Just as the parade keeper reached for the star-
WHOOOOSH!

A gust of wind swept through the square. Hats went flying.
Leaves blew everywhere. And the Monster Star rose straight off
its cushion.



“The star!” someone shouted.
Over the roofs it went, leaving a trail of gold behind it.
The wind dropped. The cushion was empty. The giant lantern
stayed dark.
Now what?



People looked under benches and behind pumpkins. Someone even checked beneath the parade wagon.

Mia spotted a tiny gold speck floating above the street. A little farther on, there was another.



“The star went that way!”

Moxie was already heading toward it. Mia followed, bucket bumping against a knee.

“Wait for me!”



They followed the specks past a porch full of pumpkins. At the steps, a child in a pumpkin costume stood beside a torn bag. Candy covered the ground.
“Oh, no. My treats!”



Mia stopped to help. While Moxie sheltered the pile from the wind, Mia picked up the scattered sweets. The neighbor brought a spare bag, and they filled it together.

“Thanks,” said the little pumpkin. “I thought I’d lost them all.”



“A few for the helpers, too,” said the neighbor, dropping treats into Mia’s bucket.

At the gate, Moxie had stopped beside a shiny wrapper. It had stars on it-and one gold speck that didn’t belong to the pattern.



“There’s our trail!” said Mia.

“Can I come?” asked the little pumpkin.

“Of course.”

The three of them set off down the street.



At the next house, a child dressed as a moon lingered by the path.

“Are you going up?” asked Mia.

The little moon looked down at the treat bucket. “I don’t know what to say.”



Moxie moved toward the porch. Mia stayed alongside.
“Come with us. We’ll say it together.”
“Trick or treat!”
The little moon’s voice was quiet, but the neighbor heard it.



While the neighbor handed out treats, something flashed in the window.

Mia looked again. A star. A bright, gold star.

“Look! In the glass!”



The Monster Star was somewhere beyond the houses. A few gold specks drifted toward the garden lane.

“We’re trying to find it,” Mia explained.

“I’ll help,” said the little moon.

Now there were four of them, with Moxie out in front.



The wind had made a mess of the garden lane. A parade banner was wound around the fence. Nobody could see which way its arrow pointed.



Mia worked a ribbon loose. The little pumpkin held the end so it wouldn't blow away again. The little moon gathered the dangling paper stars.

Beside Moxie, one last corner was still caught. They freed it, and the banner stretched out at last.

PUMPKIN PARADE - THIS WAY!



Just beyond the fence, a gold speck drifted under a garden arch. The friends stopped beneath the vines. It was quieter here. They could still hear the neighbors, but only just.



Fireflies blinked between the flowers. At the end of the path, something glowed on a low stone pedestal.

The Monster Star.

“There it is,” whispered Mia.

But the path looked different in the dark, and for a moment, nobody moved.



Then Moxie went ahead.
Mia followed. The little pumpkin and the little moon came too.
Up close, the garden was only a garden. Flowers, fallen leaves,
and a pumpkin tucked beneath a bench.



And there was the star, right where they'd seen it.
"We found it," whispered Mia.
Its light grew brighter. The whole path turned gold.



As Moxie turned back toward the arch, the star rose from the stone.

“It’s coming with us!” said Mia.

They hurried down the lane. The star floated along behind, lighting the way back to the square.



“They found it!” called the parade keeper.
The crowd made room. With the long guide pole, the keeper
eased the star onto the giant lantern.
Everyone waited.



FWOOM!

The giant pumpkin lit up. Then the pumpkin beside it. Then the next, and the next, all the way down the street.

The little pumpkin cheered. The little moon jumped. Mia nearly dropped the treat bucket.



“Well, Moxie,” said the parade keeper, “you’ve brought our star back. There’s only one thing left to do.”
The keeper stepped aside.
“Lead the parade, Monster of the Night!”



The music started, and off they went. Moxie led the Pumpkin Parade. Mia marched alongside. Behind them came the little pumpkin, the little moon, and a whole street full of waving neighbors.



By the time they got home, the bucket was full.
Mia picked out two favorite treats and set them on the table. Through the window, the Monster Star was still shining above the roofs.
“I thought we were just going trick-or-treating,” said Mia.
Then, after a yawn:
“You’re coming next Halloween too, Moxie.”



Meet Moxie!

Created by Mia



My Drawing



My Storybook Monster

Every great monster begins with a great imagination.

